

Rafael Polo

Senior Software Engineer with 20+ years designing and shipping scalable backend and data platforms.

First name: Rafael
Last name: Polo
Age: 40 years old, 13 June 1985
Citizenship: Portuguese and Brazilian. Swiss B-Visa
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Formal Education

- **Postgraduate in Data Science** – 2021
NOVA Information Management School, Lisbon
- **Master in Information Systems** – 2010–2012
Research Area: Knowledge Representation and Reasoning, PPGI/UNIRIO
- **Bachelor in Computer Science** – 2003–2009
Thesis: Agile Systems Development for Web 2.0 with Ruby on Rails

Relevant Professional Experience

- **Swisscom** – 2024 ~ Zürich, Switzerland
DevOps Engineer developing platforms for Telecommunication Operations.
- **EDGE Strategy** – 2023 ~1y – Zug, Switzerland
Senior Tech Lead managing new features and external UX & Dev Teams for a SaaS Company.
- **Moedax Digital Services** – 2018~2021 – Lisbon and Rio de Janeiro
Founder Crypto Banking – connected a Brazilian CBDC with KYC processes and on/off chain.
- **Tactical Tech Collective** – 2014~2016 – Berlin, Germany
Senior Ruby on Rails Developer under the *Exposing the Invisible Team*.
- **Trommsdorf + Drüner** – 2013~2014 – Berlin, Germany
Full-stack Engineer – Innovation Team developing Business Intelligence dashboards.
- **Cortex Intelligence** – 2007~2008 – Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
Developer in the Competitive Intelligence and Data Mining Team.
- **MeuServidor** – Co-founder – 2002~2004 – Nova Friburgo, Brazil
Co-founder of a Web Hosting Server Company in Brazil based on Linux & PHP.

ExtraPolo! – own Agency

For more than 10 years since 2008, Rafael Polo has worked as an independent Software Developer and IT Consultant, developing dozens of Projects for public and private contractors in Brazil, Portugal, Germany, Greece and Switzerland, publishing different open-source tools, bots, database mappings and visualizations.

Relevant Tech Skills

- System Analysis & Modeling with UML
- Quick Proof-of-Concepts development, deploy and management.
- Large Language Models, Gen AI, LangChain integration and Processes Automation
- MVC System Architecture, Design Patterns & Object-Oriented Programming
- Data Engineering, Data Science, Relational Databases & SQL
- Experience with Blockchain, Smart Contracts and P2P systems
- Distributing and Scaling Processes with Message Queues
- Developing Web Crawlers & Bots for Data Mining & ETL
- Linux Systems, VPS, DevOps, SSH & Deploy with Continuous Integration processes
- Projects mostly developed in Java, Python, Django, Ruby on Rails frameworks
- Full Stack Developer & Front-end Web Design with HTML, CSS and Javascript frameworks
- CI/CD, Docker, Kubernetes and Github workflows

Recent Certifications

- *Swiss Federal Act on Data Protection (nFADP)*
- *Gen AI Foundational Models for NLP & Language Understanding*
- *Generative AI and LLMs: Architecture and Data Preparation*
- *Fundamentals of AI Agents Using RAG and LangChain*

Natural Languages

- Native Brazilian Portuguese
- Advanced Spoken Spanish
- A2 level Greek – 3 years in Athens
- B1 level German / TELC proof – 3 years in Berlin and 3 in Switzerland
- Fluent English – 13 years in between international teams